

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 316

By Campbell

A RESOLUTION to commemorate Myositis Awareness Month,
May 2025.

WHEREAS, residents of the State of Tennessee are among those affected by myositis and other rare diseases, as nearly one in ten Americans have rare diseases; and

WHEREAS, idiopathic inflammatory myopathies (collectively referred to as myositis) are rare, chronic, autoimmune muscle wasting diseases; myositis often features debilitating muscle inflammation and other symptoms, including pain, fatigue, and trouble swallowing, and can result in myositis-associated interstitial lung disease; and

WHEREAS, more research is needed to identify the causes of and modes of treatments for the myositis group of diseases, which includes anti-MDA5 autoantibody positive myositis, antisynthetase syndrome, dermatomyositis, juvenile dermatomyositis, immune-mediated necrotizing myopathy, inclusion body myositis, and polymyositis; and

WHEREAS, because myositis is difficult to diagnose, treatment is often delayed, and individuals generally experience difficulty finding a healthcare provider with expertise in the condition; and

WHEREAS, all who suffer with myositis experience reduced quality of life, especially as no cure has been found, and life expectancy is shortened, especially for those with inclusion body myositis; women and people of color with all forms of myositis experience particularly pronounced health disparities; and

WHEREAS, The Myositis Association (TMA) is the leading international patient advocacy organization serving the myositis community, focusing on patient services, education, research, and public awareness, so as to achieve a world without myositis; and

WHEREAS, TMA is organizing a nationwide observance of Myositis Awareness Month during May 2025; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that that we join with The Myositis Association in its observation of May 2025 as Myositis Awareness Month.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.